ARDMORE PARISH

PARISH NEWSLETTER | SUNDAY 8 NOVEMBER 2026

32nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 25:1–13

In today's gospel, Jesus tells the parable of ten virgins who were waiting for the bridegroom. Five were wise because they brought extra oil for their lamps, while the other five were foolish because they failed to prepare. When the bridegroom finally arrived, those who were ready entered the wedding celebration, while the others were left behind.

Through this parable, Jesus reminds us of the importance of being spiritually prepared because we do not know when He will return. The lamp is a symbol of our lives, our faith, and our relationship with God. Just as a lamp needs oil to continue burning, our spiritual lives need to be constantly nourished through prayer, love, acts of kindness, and unwavering trust in the Lord.

We are called to remain vigilant and faithful, keeping our hearts close to God so that our faith never grows weak or runs dry. By living according to His will each day, we stay prepared for the return of Jesus. Rather than fearing His coming, we should look forward to it with joyful anticipation, confidence, and hope, knowing that a life rooted in faith and obedience allows us to welcome Him with hearts full of peace and devotion.

Loving God, thank You for always being with me. Help me keep the lamp of my faith burning brightly each day. May I always be ready to welcome You with joy, hope, and a faithful heart.

Prayer for All the Deceased

God our Father, Your power brings us to birth, Your providence guides our lives, and by Your command we return to dust. Lord, those who die still live in Your presence, their lives change but do not end. I pray in hope for my family, relatives and friends, and for all the dead known to You alone. In company with Christ, who died and now lives, may they rejoice in Your kingdom, where all our tears are wiped away. Unite us together again in one family to sing Your praise forever and ever. May the Divine Assistance remain always with us, and may the souls of the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace. Amen.

Sunday Readings | 15 November

First Reading	**Proverbs 31:10–13, 19–20, 30–31**
Psalm	128:1–2, 3, 4–5
Second Reading	1 Thessalonians 5:1–6
Gospel	Matthew 25:14–30

Saints of the Coming Week

Monday: The Dedication of the Lateran Basilica in Rome • Tuesday: St Leo the Great, pope and doctor of the Church • Wednesday: St Martin of Tours, bishop • Thursday: St Josaphat, bishop and martyr • Saturday: St Laurence O'Toole, bishop

Diocesan News & Pilgrimages

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes 2027

Led by Bishop Michael Router. Option 1: 8th–13th July, 5 nights, £980, departing City of Derry Airport. Priority will be given to assisted pilgrims and family members, care team, youth, youth leaders and priests. Option 2: 7th–14th July, 7 nights, £1,095, departing Belfast International Airport. Single supplement and travel insurance extra.

Expressions of interest: derrypilgrim@outlook.com. Bookings begin in January; more details to follow. Pilgrimage gift vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop St, Derry, particularly as Christmas gifts. Telephone 028 71362475.

Columban Young Adults

A relatively new group for those aged 18–35 in the diocese who seek a community of like-minded young adults with Christ at the centre of their lives. November event: Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 19th November at 7.00 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes

Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. Followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome—bring a friend! Contact columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow on social media.

Week of Witness for Persecuted Christians

One in ten Christians, 220 million people, live in countries where they are persecuted for their faith. Aid to the Church in Need is organising a Week of Witness from 15th–22nd November, with a special appeal to pray for the suffering Church on Red Wednesday, 18th November. Information: www.acnireland.org.

Vocations & Prayer

Pray for Vocations

During November, let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and parishes, as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come.

Considering a Vocation to the Diocesan Priesthood?

Meeting in Derry today (Sunday 8th November), beginning at 4.00 pm. For details contact Diocesan Vocations Director Fr Pat O'Hagan: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 79386259.

Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hour

Tuesday 1st December, 8.00–9.00 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass at St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Community Events

Dublin Gospel Choir — Sacred Heart Church, Omagh

Sunday 29th November at 6.30 pm. A magical evening of music, from traditional hymns with a modern flair to soulful gospel classics and festive favourites, featuring local primary schools. Tickets £20 from Top News, the parish office or www.eventbrite.co.uk. Proudly hosted by Droim Ratha Na Sairsealaigh with Sacred Heart Church and its Reviving Omagh's Sacred Stories Heritage Project.

Marie Curie, Strabane — Christmas Carol Service

Thursday 10th December at 7.30 pm, Christ Church, Bowling Green, Strabane. All welcome; no tickets required, donations welcome. Featuring Strabane Brass Band, Class Act singers and special guest soloist Ruth Corey. Local clergy will present scripture readings telling the Christmas story, and Fr Declan Boland will offer a personal reflection. Your presence will add to an enjoyable evening for all.

Courses, Support & Opportunities

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses available. Visit www.accordni.com.

Job Opportunity — St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry

Experienced Choir Director required (10 hours per week) to lead and manage the cathedral choir, ensuring music enhances worship and reflects liturgical themes. For job description/application pack contact (028) 71262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or recruitment@derrydiocese.org by noon Thursday 12th November 2026.

Anam Cara — Supporting Parents After Bereavement

Monthly in-person support evening: Thursday 12th November at 7.30 pm, Radisson Blu Hotel, Letterkenny, F92 FK15. No registration required. Online information event: Thursday 19th November at 7.00 pm, exploring where creativity intersects with grief, with author and psychotherapist Sasha Bates. Open to all bereaved parents, regardless of their child's age, circumstances of death or time since bereavement. Contact info@anamcara.ie or 00353 85 288 8888.